

THE LAST VIDEO STORE

Written by

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INT. THE LAST VIDEO STORE - NIGHT

Fluorescent light hums over aisles of VHS tapes. Rain streaks the front window. A hand-lettered sign reads: EVERYTHING MUST GO.

MARGO SHAW, 60s, cardigan with a pen through the pocket, alphabetizes a shelf that nobody will browse.

The bell over the door RINGS.

MARGO

We close at ten.

DEV

(O.S.)

It's nine forty.

DEV OKONKWO, 20s, soaked through, shakes off a jacket that was never waterproof.

MARGO

And yet.

DEV

I need something for a fourteen-year-old who thinks movies started with streaming.

Margo looks up for the first time.

MARGO

(a small conversion)

Sit down.

CUT TO:

INT. THE LAST VIDEO STORE - HORROR AISLE - CONTINUOUS

Margo moves like she's done this ten thousand times, because she has. Dev trails her, dripping.

MARGO

Fourteen. Scared, or pretending not to be?

DEV

Pretending. Loudly.

MARGO

Then not the one with the mask.
Everyone starts with the mask and
nobody remembers it.

She pulls a battered clamshell case and holds it like
evidence.

MARGO (CONT'D)

This one. Nothing happens for forty
minutes and then you never sleep
facing a closet again.

DEV

That's a pitch?

MARGO

That's a promise.

DISSOLVE TO:

EXT. STRIP MALL - NIGHT

Rain. The store's neon sign flickers between LAST and AST.
Behind the glass, two silhouettes argue happily about
something that doesn't matter.

DEV

(O.S.)

How long have you been here?

MARGO

(O.S.)

Since people still rewind.

INT. THE LAST VIDEO STORE - COUNTER - LATER

A shoebox of index cards. Margo writes on one in careful
block letters and slides it across.

DEV

What's this?

MARGO

Your card. Nineteen years running,
four hundred and six members.
You're four hundred and seven.

DEV

You're closing in a week.

MARGO

Then it'll be a short membership.

Dev takes the card anyway. Pockets it like it matters,
because it does.

DEV

What happens to all of it?

Margo looks down the aisles. Twenty thousand tapes. A
lifetime of other people's Friday nights.

MARGO

Somebody buys the shelves. The rest
goes where the rest goes.

DEV

That's grim.

MARGO

(not grim at all)

It's Tuesday.

SMASH CUT TO:

INT. DEV'S APARTMENT - NIGHT

A television old enough to have a dial. Dev threads the tape
in. Static, then a countdown leader -- 5, 4, 3.

His NIECE, 14, arms folded, sits as far from the screen as
the room allows.

NIECE

This is going to be so boring.

DEV

Forty minutes. Give it forty
minutes.

The countdown hits 1. The room goes dark blue.

Forty minutes later, she has not moved, and she is sitting considerably closer.

FADE OUT.